[METRIC]
A-A-1446F
March 10, 1994
SUPERSEDING
A-A-1446E
June 15, 1993

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

ENVELOPE, MAILING

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description, for all Federal agencies.

Scope.
This commercial item description covers kraft, white and color wove envelopes.

Classification.
Envelopes shall conform to the applicable style as specified:
Style A - Bleached Kraft (see 1.K)
Style B - Natural Kraft (see 1.K)
Style C - White Wove (see I.L)
Style D - Color Wove (see I.L)

1. Salient characteristics:

A. Construction. Envelopes shall be high-cut diagonal, web-fed point flap, side seam or center seam construction, at the option of the supplier, unless otherwise specified in the ordering data. Envelopes shall be sufficiently high cut so as to prevent the flap adhesive from contacting the envelope contents. The sealed seams shall not adhere to the inside of the envelope. Envelopes shall be free from cuts, folds, tears, machine marks, foreign matter, dirt, ink smears and adhesive stains.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, N.Y. 10278.

FSC 7530

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When specified (see 6.A), for use in specific automatic inserting and sealing machines, the envelopes shall meet the design and construction requirements specified by the equipment manufacturer.

B. Flap adhesive. All sealing flap adhesive shall be the water-activated type of such a consistency to prevent premature sealing of the flap and curling of the envelope after drying.

(1) The flap adhesive shall be uniformly applied and have a minimum thickness of 0.015 mm (0.0006 inch). The flaps shall be capable of being quickly and securely sealed using finger tips after moistening the adhesive. When opened 15 to 20 seconds after sealing, the flap shall pull fibers from the body of the envelope from not less than 75% of the adhesive area. The flap adhesive must cover at least 60% of the area of the flap beyond the throat, up to a maximum width of one inch gum strip from the edge of the flap.

(2) Size of flap. Unless specified in the contract/order, the minimum flap size shall be as follows:

(a) For envelopes less than 15.6 cm (6-1/8 ") x 29 cm (11-1/2") sealing flap must exceed the throat by at least 1.9 cm (3/4").

(b) For envelopes equal to or larger than 15.6 cm (6-1/8") x 29 cm (11-1/2") the sealing flap must exceed the throat by at least 3.8 cm (1-1/2"), (exception is if the automated inserting and sealing machine requires a smaller flap).

C. Split gumming. Split gumming is permitted on high-cut diagonal seams but the void shall be positioned over the seams and not exceed seam width.

D. Resin gumming. When specified (see 6.A), resin gum (temperature and humidity resistant) shall be supplied on the sealing flap. Resin gummed envelopes may have split gumming on the sealing flap. On resin gummed envelopes without split gumming, there shall be no contact between the sealing flap and the diagonal seams except the very tip of the flap. Envelopes with resin gum shall be able to withstand test storage conditions of 38° C (100° F)± 1° C (2° F) and 80 ± 2% relative humidity for 24 hours without blocking.

E. All adhesive. All adhesive shall be clean and free from offensive odor and ingredients that would discolor the paper.

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F. Windows. Windows, when specified in the ordering data, shall have rounded or slightly rounded corners, shall be the size and location specified and shall comply with all applicable U.S. Postal Service regulations. The window shall be covered on the inside with a transparent polystyrene window material glued securely on all edges so as not to interfere with insertion or contents. The transparent polystyrene window material shall be free of conditions which would prevent the address from being distinctly legible.

G. Printing. Printing shall be as specified (see 6.A) and shall comply with all applicable U.S. Postal Service and GSA Information Resources Service regulations. The envelopes shall accept printing, ink writing and bar coding without feathering, blurring, smearing, or penetrating to the reverse side.

H. Physical properties. Envelopes of styles A and B shall meet the requirements of Table 1. Envelopes of styles C and D shall meet the requirements of Table 2. Natural kraft envelopes shall be made from commercial envelope grade natural kraft with surface sizing.

I. Size. Size shall be as specified in the ordering data, and shall be outside dimensions.

J. Tolerances. A tolerance of ± 3.2 mm (± 1/8 inches) shall be allowed on the dimensions of high cut diagonal envelopes; a tolerance of ± 1.5 mm (± 1/16 inch) shall be allowed on the dimensions of all other envelopes. The tolerance on the placement of the window is ± 3.2 mm (± 1/8 inch). The dimensional tolerance on the window itself is ± 1.2 mm (± 3/64 inch).

K. Styles A and B requirements.

Style A -Bleached Kraft, white or light brown (as specified in the ordering data) 95% sulfate pulp; unbleached, and/or groundwood not to exceed 5%.
Style B -Natural kraft, 95% sulfate pulp, groundwood not to exceed 5%.

Required basis weight below shall be as specified in contract/order.

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TABLE 1

PROPERTY	REQUIREMENTS					TEST METHOD
Basis Weight g/m2 (lbs. 17x22-500) +\- 5%	75 (20#)	90 (24#)	105 (28#)	120 (32#)	150 (40#)	T410
Bursting Strength min. kpa (psi)	206 (30)	262 (38)	303 (44)	345 (50)	413 (60)	T403
Thickness,mm (inches)	0.0096-0.1224 (0.0040-0.0051)	-	-	-	-	T411
Smoothness, Sheffield Style B only average, min. max.	65 275	65 275	65 275	65 275	65 275	T518

L. Styles C and D requirements.

Style C - White, 95% bleached chemical pulp; unbleached, and/or groundwood not to exceed 5%.
Style D - Colored, 95% bleached chemical pulp; unbleached and/or groundwood not to exceed 5%; pulp dyed goldenrod, blue, green or pink, as specified in the ordering data.

Required basis weight below shall be as specified in contract/order.

TABLE 2

PROPERTY	REQUIREMENTS		TEST METHOD
Basis Weight g/m2 (lbs. 17x22-500),+\- 5%	75 (20#)	90 (24#)	T410
Bursting Strength,min kpa (psi)	138 (20)	165 (24)	T403
Opacity, avg, min % No individual measurement less than: %	86 84	89 87	T425

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2. Quality Assurance Provisions.
Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this commercial item description where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirement. Sampling shall be in accordance with Mil Std. 105 using the plans as specified in Table 3, unless stated otherwise. The sample unit for visual and dimensional examinations shall be one envelope. The sample unit for count shall be one unit package of envelopes. Preparation for delivery shall be one complete shipping container.

Table 3

Examine	Inspection Levels	AQLs (% defective)
Visual Defects	I	6.5
Examination for Dimensions	S-2	2.5
Preparation for Delivery	S-2	2.5
Count	S-2	2.5

TAPPI tests shall be in accordance with TAPPI T 400 for the applicable TAPPI test methods.

3.A. Regulatory Requirements. The contractor shall certify that the minimum content standard for the paper offered for Style C shall be no less than 20% postconsumer materials in accordance Executive Order 12873, section 504 (a), dated Oct. 20, 1993 (see definitions of postconsumer materials and recovered materials in sections 203 and 205). As an alternative to meeting the standards of section 504 (a) for all printing and writing papers, the minimum content standard shall be no less than 50% recovered materials that are a waste material byproduct of a finished product other than a paper or textile product which would otherwise be disposed of in a landfill, as determined by the State in which the facility is located, in accordance with Executive Order 12873, section 504 (c), dated Oct. 20, 1993. For Styles A, B and D the contractor shall certify that the minimum content standard shall be no less than 50% recovered materials including 20% postconsumer materials in accordance with Executive Order 12873, section 504 (b) dated Oct. 20, 1993 (see definition of postconsumer materials and recovered materials in sections 203 and 205). As an alternative to meeting the standards

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of section 504 (b) for all printing and writing papers, the minimum content standard shall be no less than 50% recovered materials that are a waste material byproduct of a finished product other than a paper or textile product which would otherwise be disposed of in a landfill,as determined by the State in which the facility is located, in accordance with Executive Order 12873, section 504 (c), dated Oct. 20, 1993. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

3.B. Bleaching. To obtain an acceptable brightness, or color, in accordance with this document, a chemical bleaching process may be used. When specified, (see 6.A), the bleaching process shall not include the use of chlorine, chlorine dioxide, hypochlorite, or other chlorine containing compound. Certification of compliance shall be made available upon request by the Government.

3.C. Labeling of Recycled Content. The recycled content shall be marked on the product or unit pack.

4. Preservation, packaging, packing, and marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

5. Referenced Documents.

(1) GSA Information Resources Management Services Regulations are available from the Commissioner, Information Resources Management Services, Washington, DC 20405.

(2) Postal regulations are available from the United States Postal Service, Rates and Classification Department, 475 L'Enfant Plaza, S.W., Washington, DC 20260-5300.

(3) TAPPI test methods are available from the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, P.O. 8ox 105113, Atlanta, GA 30348.

(4) Military Standards.
MIL-STD-105, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the U.S. Navy; Naval Publications and Form Center; 5801 Tabor Avenue; Philadelphia, PA 19120; or as directed by the contracting officer.

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(5) Executive Order 12873. Copies may be obtained free of charge by writing to: White House Publications Office, New Executive Office Building, White House, Washington D.C. 20500, Att: Publications, or calling (202)395-7332.

6. Notes.

A. Ordering Data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents. If orders are placed against an existing contract then only those factors that the contract allows may be shown on an order.

(1) Style of envelope paper (see 1K & 1L).
(2) Size of envelope (See 1I).
(3) If intended for automatic inserting and sealing machine, identify make and model (See 1A).
(4) If sealing flap size shall be other than specified (see 1.B.(2)).
(5) If resin gumming is required (see 1.D).
(6) Windows, if required (see 1.F).
(7) Printing, if required (see 1.G).
(8) Preservation, packaging, packing,and marking required (See 4).
(9) Specific Construction, if required (see 1.A).
(10) Specific Color of bleached kraft stock (see 1.K).
(11) Specific basis weight. (see 1.K & 1.L).
(12) Style D Specify color (see 1.L).
(13) Non-chlorine bleaching, if required. (see 3.B)

B. Item Identifiers/Reference Part Number System (For Cataloging Use Only).

AA1446-1 :This example describes a bleached kraft mailing
| : envelope.
|
|———Style 1- Style A - Bleached Kraft
2- Style B - Natural Kraft
3- Style C - White Wove
4- Style D - Color Wove

MILITARY INTERESTS:
Activity:
Custodians:
Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 99
Review Activites:
Navy - CG, MC
Air Force - 84

Preparing
GSA-FSS

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